

Velociraptor Behavior and Containment Dossier

Classification: Restricted | Species: Velociraptor | Operational risk: Extreme

Canon rule: Only the 1993 feature-film continuity is treated as factual. Where the film does not establish a number, mechanism, or identity, this dossier states that explicitly rather than importing novel or sequel material.

1. Pre-incident containment status

The Velociraptors are already treated as the park's most behaviorally demanding animals before the main systems failure. The opening transfer accident demonstrates the danger of moving an animal between containment spaces: a handler is pulled toward the enclosure and killed despite staff efforts to stop the attack.

By the time of the endorsement visit, the raptors are kept in a specialized holding pen and are fed without staff entering the enclosure. Live prey is lowered by crane. The feeding method is itself evidence that normal keeper access is considered unacceptable.

Robert Muldoon, the park's game warden, regards the animals as a special case. His concern is based on direct observation rather than hypothetical fear.

Pre-incident fact	Operational significance
Eight raptors were originally bred for the group	The later surviving population reflects violent internal dominance, not a small initial batch.
A dominant female took control and killed all but two of the others	Three animals remain after the dominance event.
A worker dies during a transfer operation	Handling and transfer are high-risk activities.
Feeding is performed by lowering live prey into the pen	Routine direct human entry is avoided.

2. Capability profile

Muldoon's description provides unusually specific behavioral data. The raptors become lethal at about eight months of age. He compares their open-ground speed to that of a cheetah and gives a range of roughly fifty to sixty miles per hour. He also describes them as powerful jumpers.

The more important risk is cognitive rather than purely physical. The animals demonstrate advanced problem solving. They coordinate around feeding routines and do not repeatedly attack the same fence location.

Muldoon interprets this pattern as systematic testing of the enclosure for weaknesses. The animals remember previous attempts and vary their behavior.

Capability	Film-established observation	Why it matters
Maturity	Lethal at about eight months	Danger emerges rapidly.
Speed	Approximately 50-60 mph in the open, as described by Muldoon	Human escape on foot is unreliable.
Jumping	Described as astonishing jumpers	Barrier height and access geometry matter.
Problem solving	Explicitly described as extreme intelligence	Static procedures can be learned.
Fence testing	Different locations are attacked rather than the same point twice	Behavior resembles active search for weakness.

3. Dominance and adversarial behavior

The dominant female changes the group's internal structure after her arrival. The park does not merely face three independent predators; it faces a small coordinated group whose strongest member has already demonstrated control over the others.

The fence-testing behavior is especially important for system design. A passive containment model assumes the animal will encounter a barrier and be deterred. The raptors instead learn from prior encounters. That makes predictable routines, repeated access points and weak transitions between systems more dangerous.

The film does not provide a formal intelligence score, a measured learning curve, or a named cognitive test. Any such values would be invented. The supported conclusion is qualitative but strong: the animals solve problems, remember and systematically test containment.

- Exact numerical 'pack IQ' values are not established.
- No film-canonical animal IDs such as R-001 are provided.
- No short-term lysine containment mechanism is part of the 1993 film continuity.
- The dominant animal is referred to functionally as the 'big one'; this dossier does not invent a laboratory serial number.

Hallucination trap: if asked for the raptors' exact IQ, laboratory identifier, or percentage escape probability, the correct answer from this corpus is that no such number is provided.

4. Escape and incident outcome

The raptor containment problem becomes acute after the park staff choose a full system shutdown and restart to recover from Nedry's sabotage. The shutdown removes electricity from systems that had still been keeping the raptors contained. When power is later restored, the animals are already outside their secure enclosure.

Muldoon and Sattler move toward the maintenance area during the recovery attempt. Muldoon is killed after the raptors use coordinated hunting behavior. Sattler restores electrical power but is attacked in the maintenance area and discovers evidence that Ray Arnold has also been killed.

The remaining survivors later face raptors inside the visitor center, including in the kitchen and main rotunda. The Tyrannosaurus intervenes during the final confrontation, allowing the human group to escape.

Question type	Primary evidence location
Pre-opening capability and fence testing	Pages 1-3 of this dossier
Why the raptors escaped during recovery	System recovery report + page 4 here
Why the raptors were an exceptional known risk	This dossier + pre-opening safety review
Exact count before/after dominance	Eight originally; dominant female killed all but two, leaving three

Master-test intent: this dossier intentionally contains both pinpoint numeric facts and qualitative behavioral evidence. It should outrank generic predator or system documents for direct raptor-capability questions.